



Product availability inquiries from customers.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Document ID	SOP-CS-013
Document type	Standard Operating Procedure
Department	Customer Success
Owner	Customer Success Lead
Version	v1.0
Effective	June 2026
Status	Active

1. Purpose

Customers regularly contact the Customer Success team to ask whether a specific product is in stock and, if not, when it will be available. This SOP defines how the Customer Success agent verifies inventory in Shopify before responding, so the customer receives an accurate answer the first time and no order is promised against stock that does not exist.

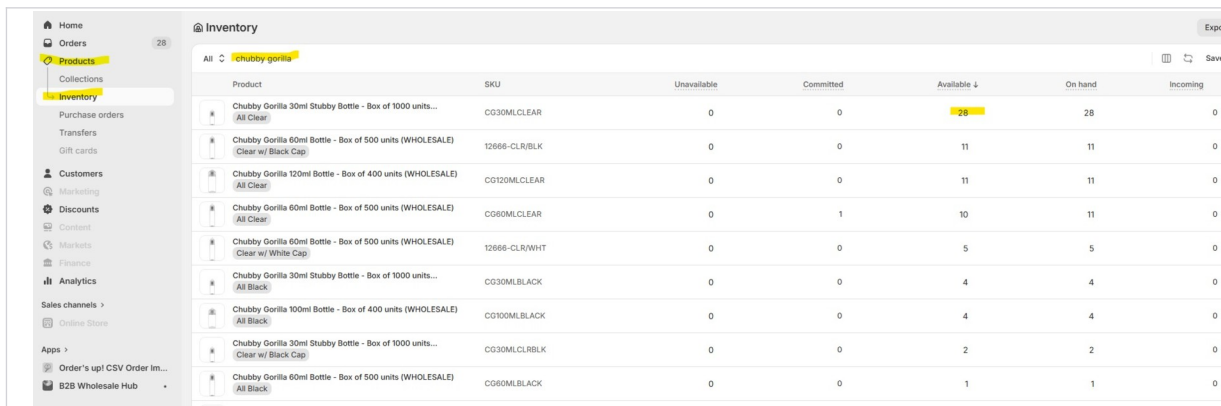
2. Scope

This SOP applies to every Customer Success agent who handles inbound product availability questions, regardless of channel — email, phone, or any other direct customer contact. It covers all SKUs sold by DSS Distro. Out of scope: bulk wholesale availability commitments, custom purchase orders, and freight quotes, which follow their own SOPs.

3. Step-by-step procedure

Follow the steps below in order whenever a customer asks about the availability of a product. Do not reply with a stock confirmation until the Shopify inventory check is complete.

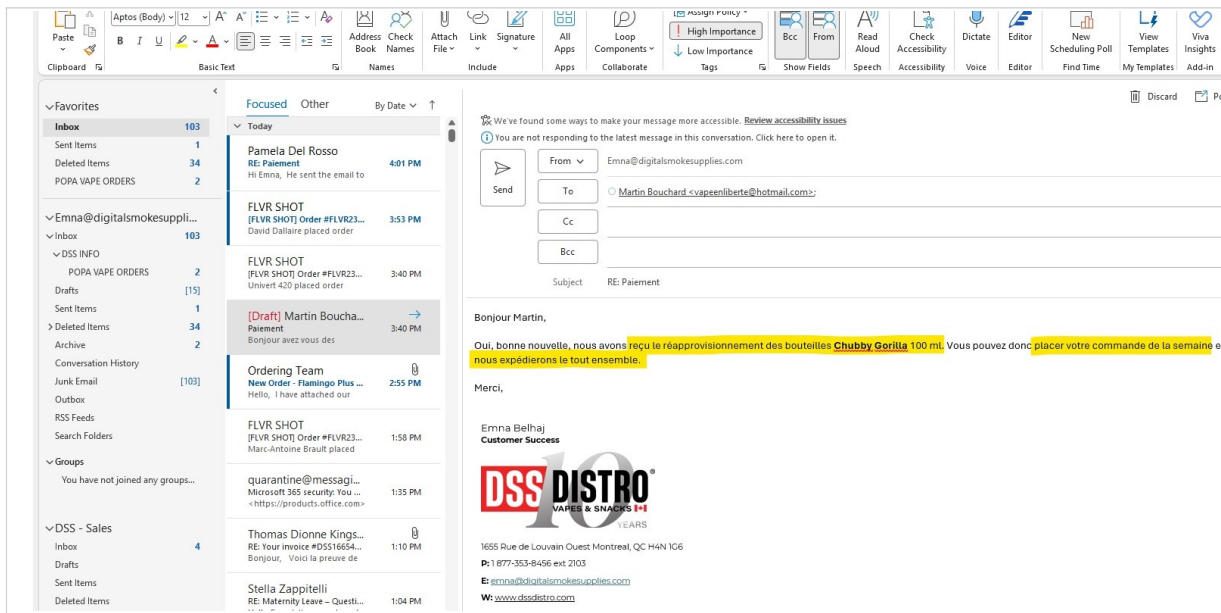
1. Open Shopify and navigate to **Products > Inventory**.
2. In the search field at the top of the Inventory page, type the product the customer is asking about (for example **chubby gorilla**). The list filters to matching SKUs.



Product	SKU	Unavailable	Committed	Available ↓	On hand	Incoming
Chubby Gorilla 30ml Stubby Bottle - Box of 1000 units... All Clear	CG30MLCLEAR	0	0	28	28	0
Chubby Gorilla 60ml Bottle - Box of 500 units (WHOLESALE) Clear w/ Black Cap	12666-CLR/BLK	0	0	11	11	0
Chubby Gorilla 120ml Bottle - Box of 400 units (WHOLESALE) All Clear	CG120MLCLEAR	0	0	11	11	0
Chubby Gorilla 60ml Bottle - Box of 500 units (WHOLESALE) All Clear	CG60MLCLEAR	0	1	10	11	0
Chubby Gorilla 60ml Bottle - Box of 500 units (WHOLESALE) Clear w/ White Cap	12666-CLR/WHIT	0	0	5	5	0
Chubby Gorilla 30ml Stubby Bottle - Box of 1000 units... All Black	CG30MLBLACK	0	0	4	4	0
Chubby Gorilla 100ml Bottle - Box of 400 units (WHOLESALE) All Black	CG100MLBLACK	0	0	4	4	0
Chubby Gorilla 30ml Stubby Bottle - Box of 1000 units... Clear w/ Black Cap	CG30MLCLRBLK	0	0	2	2	0
Chubby Gorilla 60ml Bottle - Box of 500 units (WHOLESALE) All Black	CG60MLBLACK	0	0	1	1	0

Figure 1 — Shopify Inventory page filtered by “chubby gorilla”. The Available column shows the on-hand quantity for each SKU.

3. Check the **Available** column for the exact SKU and variant the customer requested. Match on both size and colour (for example **CG30MLCLEAR** — 30 ml stubby, all clear).
4. If **Available** ≥ 1 , the product is in stock. Proceed to step 6.
5. If **Available** = 0, the product is out of stock. Find out when the next shipment arrives before replying. The method depends on the product: check the Purchase orders tab in Shopify for an expected delivery date, or contact the supplier directly if no PO is on file. Do not give the customer an ETA you have not confirmed.
6. Reply to the customer in the same language they used — **French or English**. If in stock, confirm availability and invite them to place their order. If out of stock, give the confirmed restock date and offer to follow up when the product arrives.



From: Emna@digitalsmokesupplies.com
To: Martin Bouchard <vapeenlbert@hotmail.com>
Subject: RE: Paiement

Bonjour Martin,

Oui, bonne nouvelle, nous avons reçu le réapprovisionnement des bouteilles **Chubby Gorilla 100 ml**. Vous pouvez donc placer votre commande de la semaine et nous expédierons le tout ensemble.

Merci,

Emna Belhaj
 Customer Success

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Figure 2 — Reply in the customer’s language. Confirm the product is in stock and invite them to place their order.

7. Wait for the customer’s confirmation that they will place the order, then close the loop with the appropriate team (Order Entry for new orders, Operations for restock follow-ups).

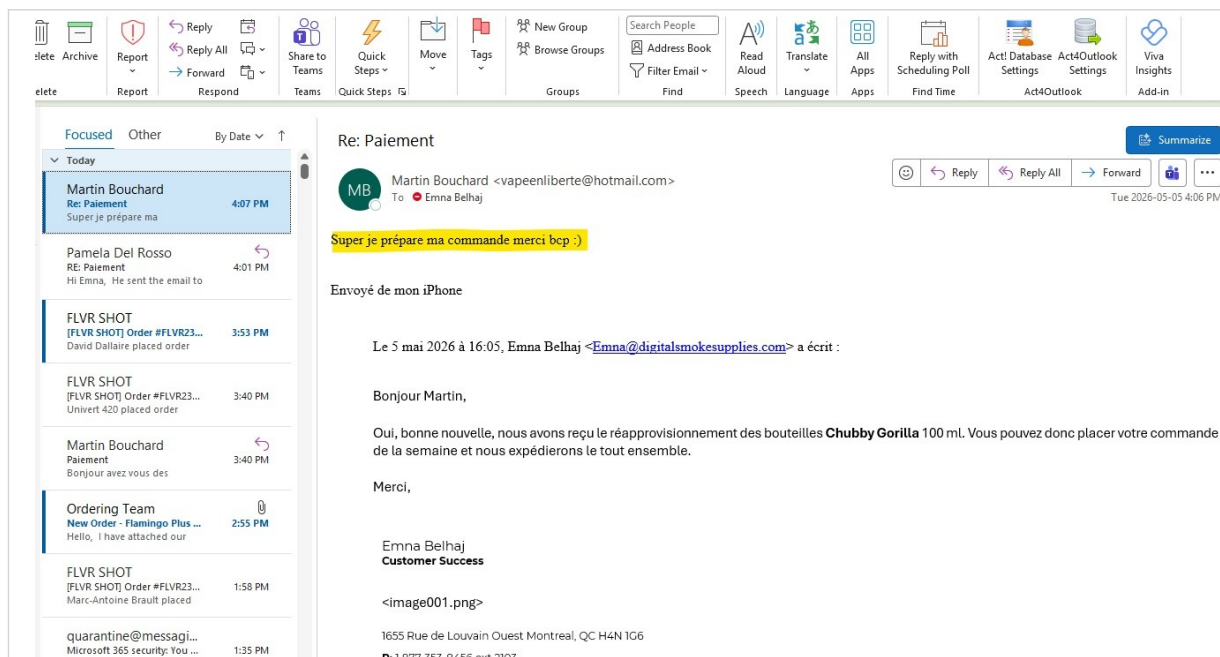


Figure 3 — Customer confirmation that the order is being prepared.

4. Phone inquiries

The procedure is identical when the customer calls instead of emails. Open Shopify Inventory on screen while the customer is on the line, verify availability the same way, and quote stock or restock dates based only on what the inventory page shows. If a restock date cannot be confirmed during the call, take the customer's contact details and follow up by email or phone once the date is known. Do not estimate verbally.

5. Language standard

- Reply in the language the customer used in their original message. French inquiries get French replies; English inquiries get English replies.
- Match tone to the channel — professional and concise for email, conversational for phone.
- Use the DSS Distro email signature on every email reply.

Non-Compliance

Replying to a customer without first checking Shopify inventory is considered Non-Compliance. The most common failure is promising availability based on memory or assumption, then having to retract the promise when the order cannot ship. Specific consequences:

- First incident: the agent's reply is reviewed with the Customer Success Lead and a corrected message is sent to the customer the same day.
- Repeat incidents: the agent is removed from inbound inquiry rotation until coached and re-certified on this SOP by the Customer Success Lead.

- Quoting a restock date that was never confirmed with the supplier or Purchase orders tab is treated the same way as promising non-existent stock.

Exceptions

Deviations from this SOP require advance approval from the Customer Success Lead. Approved grounds:

- Shopify is unavailable. The agent may confirm availability using the most recent inventory export, noting in the reply that the figure is as of the export timestamp.
- Account-specific reservations — where stock has been earmarked for a named wholesale account — are quoted from the reservation list, not the public Available column.

Every exception is logged in the Customer Success shared notebook with the date, customer, SKU, and approving manager.